A-A-54553
31 December 1991

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

MASK, SURGICAL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Federal Specification DDD-M-136b which is cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers surgical masks used by personnel in operating rooms and by other personnel in maintaining protective aseptic techniques.

Salient characteristics:

The surgical mask shall consist of single-ply filter fabric such as canton flannel or double-nap outing flannel, covered on each side with a single ply of gauze, neatly sewn along all edges so that no raw edges or loose threads are exposed. Two tucks shall be sewn into each of the two sides reducing the length by approximately one half. There shall be no less than 16 stitches per inch. Gauze shall be made from thoroughly clean cotton, free from waste. The gauze shall be bleached, shall be free from loading matter, and shall be substantially free from particles other than cotton.

There shall be two 1/2 inch wide tie tabs of cotton tape securely sewn across the outside top and bottom of the mask approximately 1/8 inch from the edges of the mask and extending beyond the edges of the mask for a distance of not less than 14 inches. The tapes shall be double sewn parallel to and approximately 1/8 inch from each edge of the tape, and the sewing shall extend not less than 1-1/2 inches beyond the edges of the mask. There shall be not less than eight stitches per inch.

All stitching used in the construction of the mask shall be of the lock stitch type.

Thread used in the manufacturing of the surgical mask shall be cotton machine thread 3-ply or heavier, ticket number 50.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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The mask shall be essentially rectangular in shape, measuring, when new, and with tucks extended, approximately 7 inches, plus or minus 1/2 inch in nose, mouth and chin dimensions (referred to as length) and approximately 7-1/4 inches plus or minus 1/4 inch in the cheek to cheek dimension (referred to as width). The length of the finished mask with the tuck unextended shall be approximately 3-5/8 inches plus or minus 2/8 inch.

The mask shall be either white or green. If green, the gauze, tie tabs, binding tape and thread shall be a uniform, grayish-green. The color of the fabric in the mask shall be obtained by vat-dyeing and shall show good fastness after 15 hospital launderings.

The use of dyes and compounds containing elementary sulfur capable of oxidation to sulfuric acid is prohibited.

The mask shall be free from abrasion marks, cuts, holes, tears, weak or soft spots, loose threads, and broken yarns. Shrinkage shall be 2 percent or less when tested in accordance with American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists (AATCC) 135, Method IIIB. Yarn count shall be 180 yarns per square inch in accordance with ASTM D1910.

Workmanship. The surgical mask shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing one hundred and twenty masks, as specified, constitutes one unit.

QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item. Sample masks shall be examined for consumer type defects: holes, cuts, tears, and loose or missing components.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one mask.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests, including dimensional test, shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-2. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one mask.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerance specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction , the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered material. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	Item Identification
6515-00-299-9597	MASK, SURGICAL, GAUZE, 120s.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

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CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-5066

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1 The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8 In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.

2 The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7

3 The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1 DOCUMENT NUMBER A-A-54553	2 DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 31 December 1991

3 DOCUMENT TITLE MASK, SURGICAL

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite if possible Attach extra sheets as needed.)

5 REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)
	e. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8 PREPARING ACTIVITY

a NAME	b TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON
Defense Personnel Support Center	(215) 737-2870	444-2870
c ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) ATTN: MSE 2800 S. 20th Street Philadelphia, PA 19145	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT. Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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